It's Great to Be a Cow in World of Warcraft: Forever

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Mulgore is home to the **tauren**, cow-like people in World of Warcraft. Right now, it is great to be a **tauren**.

Long ago, **tauren** learned a skill called **Plainsrunning**. In the first test version, **tauren** did not get horses at level 40, likely because they were too big. Instead, they could run as fast as a horse.

That idea did not last. **Tauren** were given **kodos** to ride instead, and **Plainsrunning** was forgotten for years.

Then it came back in WoW: Forever. This time, **tauren** got faster the longer they ran, as long as they did not stop or fight.

After the test ended, **Blizzard** made it better. Now **tauren** can run 60 percent faster. That is as fast as a first mount, which players do not get until level 40. But **tauren** can use it at level 1.

It takes time to reach top speed. **Tauren** get one stack every few seconds, and each stack adds 2 percent, up to 30 stacks. Still, **tauren** are now zooming across **Mulgore**. You will need a horse to catch this cow!

Word Treasure

Mulgore -- Mulgore is the grassy home land of the tauren in the game.

tauren -- Tauren are cow-like people who live in the game world.

Plainsrunning -- Plainsrunning is a tauren skill that lets them run very fast on foot.

kodos -- Kodos are big rideable animals that tauren use instead of horses.

Blizzard -- Blizzard is the company that makes World of Warcraft.

Background you need

Plainsrunning is a special skill that lets tauren, the cow-like people of World of Warcraft, run as fast as a horse without riding one.

Long ago, tauren did not get horses because they were too big, so they learned to run fast on their own instead.

The skill was forgotten for years, but it came back in WoW: Forever, and now tauren get faster the longer they keep running.

Break it down

WHO: The tauren, cow-like people in World of Warcraft, and Blizzard, which brought back their running skill.

WHAT: Plainsrunning returned in WoW: Forever and was improved so tauren can run 60 percent faster, as fast as a first mount.

WHERE: Mulgore, the tauren homeland, where tauren are now zooming across the land.

WHY: Tauren were too big for horses at level 40 in the first test version, so they were given a running skill instead, and now it lets them travel fast from level 1.

Why it matters

If you play a game, it shows how one small change can make starting out feel faster and more fun right from level 1.

Test what you remember

1. Where do the tauren live?

- (A) Azeroth's capital city
- (B) Mulgore
- (C) A horse ranch
- (D) The kodo stables

2. What is the name of the skill that lets tauren run as fast as a horse?

- (A) Horseback riding
- (B) Plainsrunning
- (C) Kodo racing
- (D) Flying on a mount

3. In the first test version, why did tauren probably not get horses at level 40?

- (A) They lived too far from the stables
- (B) They were too slow
- (C) They did not like horses
- (D) They were too big

4. After Plainsrunning was dropped long ago, what were tauren given to ride instead?

- (A) Dragons
- (B) Wolves
- (C) Kodos
- (D) Horses

5. How much faster can tauren run now?

- (A) 20 percent faster
- (B) 40 percent faster
- (C) 60 percent faster
- (D) 100 percent faster

6. At what level can tauren use Plainsrunning now?

- (A) Level 20
- (B) Level 1
- (C) Level 10
- (D) Level 40

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: D 4: C 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):